Kevin Rajan

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Education

University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign — Urbana-Champaign, IL
Bachelor of Science in Engineering Physics, Minor in Computer Science — *Aug. 2016 – May 2020*

Experience

Founder & CEO — 2023 – Present
zero, LLC — *Remote*

- Built continuous research systems to synthesize population-level trends to formulate preventative health solutions
- Prototyped OS-level automation for end-to-end product management, enabling LLMs to use internal, application-level APIs, resulting in complex workflows spanning multiple platforms and applications
- Designed digital twin simulations to prototype AI factories and industrialize feedback loops implementing systems-thinking
- Implemented efficient, reproducible development environments (NixOS, Ubuntu, Arch, Kubernetes) for on-prem compute, reducing operating costs by 50%

LLM Training Specialist — 2022 – 2023
Outlier (Scale AI) — *Remote*

- Designed and applied detailed rubrics for LLM evaluation, writing complex logic, math, and physics prompts to elicit reasoning failures and guide model improvement through process-supervision feedback
- Performed red-teaming and fact-checking across STEM and general-knowledge domains, verifying claims with web sources
- Conducted large-scale preference labeling and comparative ranking of multiple LLMs (RLHF, DPO, RLAIF)
- Developed multimodal and tool-use evaluations integrating text, image, and retrieval tasks to measure grounding and reasoning depth

Ultralearning Sabbatical — 2021 – 2022
Self-Directed — *Remote*

- Engineered a holistic performance optimization system applying an algorithmic feedback loop (Research, Implement, Analyze, Iterate) to systematically correlate and refine inputs including sleep, nutrition, and training protocols
- Executed data-driven analysis to benchmark rapid skill acquisition, achieving validated performance metrics within the top 1-5% of a 25M+ user environment

Senior Consultant — Aug. 2018 – 2021
Slalom Consulting — *Chicago, IL*

- Collaborated within a multi-disciplinary team to enhance client (4B+ revenue finance firm) engagement while modernizing technology systems across 12 teams and verticals using AWS, Jenkins, Terraform, and Vault
- Improved developer impact by creating tailored CI/CD pipelines that publish biweekly golden Windows and RHEL releases, ensuring security standards within custom AMIs
- Championed a comprehensive DevOps training program tailored for over 500 new hires, designing engaging onboarding sessions fostering collaboration and hands-on learning
- Steered the conceptualization of a preventative health platform as product owner, orchestrating diverse health data sources from wearables to metabolic panels

Additional Experience

Software Engineer Intern (EC2 Fargate) — Summer 2018
Amazon Web Services — *Seattle, WA*

- Increased response time in identifying customer container issues by integrating pool metrics for developers
- Automated customer compute capacity management through algorithmic traffic spike detection

IT Enterprise Architect Intern — Jun. 2018 – Aug. 2018
BlueCross BlueShield — *Chicago, IL*

- Executed projects contributing to HCSC's enterprise data strategy

iOS Engineer / UX Engineer Jul. 2017 – Feb. 2018

Prenosis Inc. *Champaign, IL*

- Designed an iOS application enabling physicians to manage patients' lab results, vitals, and imaging statistics
- Integrated Prenosis Number risk stratification feature for patient prioritization

Leadership

iOS Developer / Open Source Coordinator / Sponsorship 2015 – 2018

HackIllinois *Champaign, IL*

- Developed iOS app for 15,000+ attendees; raised $300K+ in sponsorships from 120+ corporations
- Managed open source initiative attracting leading technology firms; invited 40 mentors nationwide

Technical Skills

Languages: Python, C++, C, Java, Haskell, Swift, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, SQL
DevOps & Cloud: AWS, Terraform, Jenkins, Azure, Kubernetes, Docker, Git, CI/CD Pipelines
AI & LLMs: Claude Code, Codex, Gemini CLI, Cursor, MCP Servers, Context Engineering, RLHF, DPO
Data & Analytics: pandas, NumPy, Tableau, PowerBI, Matplotlib
iOS & Design: Xcode, Swift, CocoaPods, Firebase, Figma, Sketch